

SOC INCIDENT REPORT

Brute-Force Account Compromise

CRITICAL
Simulated lab

Incident ID SOC-LAB-2026-001	Date September 3, 2026	Prepared by Banjou Drame	Environment Splunk Enterprise / soc_lab
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Executive Summary

Splunk analysis identified **eight failed login attempts** from **10.10.10.50** against the **admin** account on the **vpn-gateway**. A successful login followed, then a successful privilege change and a firewall configuration change. This sequence is consistent with brute-force credential compromise followed by post-authentication activity.

Incident Timeline

Time	Observed activity	Asset	Assessment
10:09:44-10:11:38	8 failed admin login attempts	vpn-gateway	Brute-force pattern
10:11:55	Login succeeded	vpn-gateway	Probable compromise
10:12:14	Privilege change succeeded	vpn-gateway	Privilege escalation
10:12:48	Configuration change succeeded	firewall-01	Security control modified

Key Indicators

Source IP: 10.10.10.50
Target account: admin
Affected assets: vpn-gateway, firewall-01
Failed authentications: 8 within approximately 2 minutes

Detection

Splunk alert threshold: **5 or more failed logins from the same source in 5 minutes**. The scheduled search runs every 5 minutes and adds matches to Triggered Alerts.

Risk and Potential Impact

The successful admin login after repeated failures indicates likely unauthorized access. The subsequent privilege and firewall changes could enable persistence, weaken network controls, or support further movement through the environment.

Analyst determination: Immediate investigation and containment required.

Recommended Response

1. Block 10.10.10.50 at the VPN and firewall.	4. Review and restore unauthorized firewall changes; check for persistence or lateral movement.
2. Disable the admin account, reset its credentials, and terminate active sessions.	5. Require MFA and apply account lockout or rate limiting to reduce recurrence.
3. Isolate affected assets and preserve relevant authentication and configuration logs.	Status: Investigated in a controlled, simulated lab.

Simulated SOC/SIEM portfolio exercise. No real systems, accounts, or personal data were affected. Evidence source: soc_lab_security_events.csv analyzed in Splunk Enterprise.